

SIX ADVANCED PROMPT WRITING TIPS

for better results

1. Write clear instructions

- Clarify your request:** Ensure your requests are detailed and contextual to minimize guessing by AI for more accurate responses. Be specific on what you are asking for.

Worse	Better
How do I add numbers in Excel?	How do I add up a row of dollar amounts in Excel? I want to do this automatically for a whole sheet of rows with all the totals ending up on the right in a column called "Total".

- Persona adoption:** When creating your inquiry, ask AI to adapt a persona, like a role play to get more specialized and personalized outputs.

Worse	Better
Explain photosynthesis.	Act as a high school biology teacher and explain photosynthesis to a 10th-grade class.

- Step-by-step directions:** Specifying tasks in detailed steps helps the AI tool like ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot or Gemini, follow and complete them more effectively.

Worse	Better
Tell me how to make a cake.	List the steps to bake a chocolate cake, starting with preheating the oven and ending with applying frosting.

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- Providing examples:** Giving AI tool examples of the type of output you're looking for could assist in reducing the chance of it misinterpreting what you want.

Worse	Better
Generate email subject lines for the tech start up brand awareness.	Generate 5 email subject lines for the tech start-up brand awareness campaign that mimics the upbeat and inviting style of this example: "Your Gateway to Tech Excellence: [Tech Startup's Name]."

- Length specification:** Specify target lengths for desired outputs, like number of paragraphs or bullet points, for more reliable results than specifying word counts.

Worse	Better
Make this article shorter, around 100 words.<Article>:	Summarize this article in three bullet points for a concise overview. <Article>:

2. Ask to criticize and reason its answers

- Asking to reason:** To get more concise answer, guide AI to think step-by-step from the basics, asking to reason from first principles before coming to a conclusion.

Worse	Better
Check the math problem and solution below and determine if the student's solution is correct or not. <Problem>:.....	First work out your own solution to the problem given below. Then compare your solution to the student's solution and evaluate if the student's solution is correct or not. Don't decide if the student's solution is correct until you have done the problem yourself. <Problem>:.....

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- **Ask if it missed anything on previous passes:** Better performance can often be obtained by prompting AI with follow-up queries to find anything is missed on previous passes.

Example:

Prompt 1: Summarize this long text in 3 paragraphs. Keep important facts & figures related to finance.
Text: "" "" "" ""

Output:
[Model gives an answer with the summary]....

Prompt 2: Double check and make sure if you include all the important points related to finance.

3. Split complex tasks into simpler tasks

- **Splitting complex instructions into smaller subtasks** can help keep AI focus on each subtask and provide more accurate and precise answers.

Worse	Better
Summarize the text using the original language of the text. The summary should be one sentence long. Text: "" ""La estadística..... "" ""	1) First, identify the language of the text. 2) Second, summarize the text using the original language of the text. The summary should be one sentence long. Text: "" ""La estadística..... "" ""

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4. Use chain-of-thought prompting

- **When you ask a question, request AI to “think step by step”:** Eventually you are asking it to “think out loud,” rather than simply providing a direct solution. This allows you to get more accurate answer with the reasoning behind the answer.

Example:

Prompt:

I went to the market and bought 10 apples. I gave 2 apples to the neighbor and 2 to the repairman. I then went and bought 5 more apples and ate 1. How many apples did I remain with?

Output: 11

In the example above, you asked a question and got an answer which is incorrect!
Now, let's try chain-of-thought prompting!

Prompt:

I went to the market and bought 10 apples. I gave 2 apples to the neighbor and 2 to the repairman. I then went and bought 5 more apples and ate 1. How many apples did I remain with?
Let's think step by step.

Output:

First, you started with 10 apples. You gave away 2 apples to the neighbor and 2 to the repairman, so you had 6 apples left. Then you bought 5 more apples, so now you had 11 apples.
Finally, you ate 1 apple, so you would remain with 10 apples.

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5. Experiment and iterate

- Refine your prompts:** Don't hesitate to adjust wording based on AI responses. Iteration is key.

Example:

Prompt 1: Explain quantum physics in a clear way.

Output:

[Model gives an answer]

Prompt 2: That is still difficult to understand. Create a simplified version and also provide a concise explanation of the Schrödinger equation.

6. Provide reference text

- Utilize texts references:** If we offer AI with reliable data relevant to the present query, we can ask it to utilize that information to assemble its response.

Worse	Better
Answer my questions below: Q1)... Q2)...	Check the provided article below which is delimited by triple quotes "" to answer my questions. If the answer cannot be found in the article, response "I could not find an answer." Here is the article: <insert article>: